

WHIDBEY ISLAND HORSE COUNCIL
Meeting Minutes: August 5, 2026

The meetings called to order at 6:30pm by coordinator Sally Garratt. Eight people were in attendance in person and on zoom.

Website:

Karena discussed the Horse Council website. It is being developed by Vicki and is not “live” yet. We were able to see an initial version at cchsvickie.github.io. Vickie will be unavailable for a while this summer but will be working on it when she returns. Vickie will not be the Admin so someone to do that is needed.

Resource Directory.

The Resource Directory is being developed and will allow businesses and equine related activities to submit information into the directory and update that information online. The Directory will be available to any person on (or connected to) Whidbey’s equine community. Admins are needed to monitor and update the Directory. That Admin could be someone who does not ride but wants to be connected to the equine community on the Island. A suggestion was made to target next March as the launch of the Directory and maybe schedule a potluck dinner or some kind of community get together for the launch.

Topics for the Resource Directory could include:

- Businesses with equine related products
- Hay sources
- Farriers
- Horse clubs
- Trainers
- Veteranarians
- Trailer info, repair, maintenance, sales and resales
- Trail maps and contact info for trail and maintenance info
- Trailer sharing opportunities
- Equine related legal info; RCWs and other related legal info
- Safety info including disaster and emergency preparedness
- Notices of meetings and other horse related events

Needed: people to be Admins, someone to review content of each topic,

Whidbey equine economic impact survey

On hold while the website and the resource directory are being developed. Could be included in the Directory and be introduced via the website. Needs review based on developing those areas.

Emergency Plans

Whidbey Island Trail Riders meeting on August 17th will include a presentation of emergency planning for equine owners. All are invited.

Greenbank Farm

Sally and Barb discussed the possibility of using Greenbank Farm for equine related activities including a Trail obstacle course or cross-country course. Sandy suggested we look at Sunset Farms (near the Border) as a model for Whidbey. She will check it out. Sally and Barb will talk with the Port Commissioners about possible GBF uses.

The meeting was adjourned at 8pm. The next WIHC meeting will be rescheduled because of summer conflicts.

